



Biography Writing

LOs:

- To understand biographies in detail, including their purpose, key characteristics, and examples
- To learn about the conventions of biographies.

Use the many to answer the question.

What is a Biography?

- A true story about a person's life written by someone else.
- Tells a story about famous or ordinary people who have done exciting things. They usually center on one person's life and how they have contributed to the world.
- Belongs to the genre of nonfiction
- Should not be confused with autobiography, which is a person's own account of their life written by him or her.

Person	What are they famous for?	Biography Title
Helen Keller	First person with deafblindness to earn a college degree.	"The Story of My Life"
Dr. Seuss	Children's author	"Becoming Dr. Seuss"
Cristopher Columbus	A famous explorer	"Across the Ocean Sea"
Martin Luther King	Civil Rights leader	"Martin Luther King Jr.: A Life"
Malala Yousafzai	Child rights activist - women's right to education	"I am Malala"
Usain Bolt	Fastest Runner	"The fastest man alive - The true story of Usain Bolt"
Dr. Abdul Kalam Abad	Scientist	"Wings of Fire"

What are the conventions of Biographies?

- Biographies give facts about important people or a written account of someone's life.
- Biographies include incidents from a person's life chronologically and begins with birth and ends with that person's death
- They describe a person's importance to the world or why they are famous
- Biographies may include descriptions of the person's personality so that the reader ~~can~~ can visualize meeting that person.
- Biographies use photos to show what the person looked like in different points in their life.
- It takes a ~~short~~ narrative form but is a non-fiction text and intent is inspirational.

LO:

11/12/2025

- To read in groups and analyze the text to identify the conventions of a biography.

Provocation:

- Gives facts about the life of an important person
- Main intent is inspirational
- Includes incidents from a person's life in chronological order

~~Group Activity~~



Group Activity:

Q1. What information is provided here? What do they add to the biography?

A4.

~~A1. Information about Barkhad Abdi's life and achievements~~

2. Why have these key events been included? What impact do they have on the readers?

A5.

3. What do we learn about his achievements?

4. Why does Abdi deserve a biography?

5. Comment on the structure of the biography.

Refer to the Sample answers (uploaded on Drive) for self-assessment.

Answers:

A1. Information about Barkhad Abdi's life and achievements are written in chronological order, starting from his childhood and ending in his current life. ~~These~~ They add the challenges he faced, his childhood in Somalia, and how he ended up moving to the US.

A2. These key events were included to show Abdi's ~~extraordinary~~ path to success as well as his achievements and challenges faced. ~~The impact left~~ After reading Abdi's life story, readers are meant to get inspired and do something good for the world too.

A3. We learn about some of his key achievements, such as being nominated for a Golden Globe, an Oscar, and winning the BAFTA for Best Supporting Actor, which show his success.



A4. Abdi deserves a biography because 'even though he faced many challenges, he overcame them and eventually became a successful person, so he is worthy of a biography.'

A5. The structure of the biography is in chronological order, with descriptions of key events at different points in his life.

Consider the word limit while writing (this needs to be done in 100 - 120 words). Please write it again.

Give